

Illustrative Four-Square constitutional overlay only — not upstream Django governance.

PROJECT CONSTITUTION / CONTRACT / LETTERHEAD

FOUR-SQUARE RELEASE LINEAGE

main1 = repository first commit / immutable root reference

SPEC spec-v1.2	CODE code-v1.2	DOCS docs-v1.2	MEMORY memory-v1.2
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SPEC and MEMORY are fixed. The two middle lanes are project-defined and **SHOULD** remain stable across versions.

CONSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE

MUST / MUST NOT binding law	SHALL / SHALL NOT constitutional alias	SHOULD / SHOULD NOT strong guidance	MAY permitted option	EXCEPTION / WAIVER explicit departure
MISSION Provide a coherent framework for building database-backed web applications with mature integrated facilities.		CORE PRINCIPLE CODE and DOCS SHOULD remain aligned; deviations SHOULD be explicit.	BOUNDARY Application business logic and deployment policy remain with consuming projects.	

CONSTITUTIONAL HIERARCHY / FORMS

CONSTITUTION → ARTICLES / LAWS → CONTRACTS → POLICIES → GUARDRAILS → RECOMMENDED PRACTICES → CHECKLISTS

The form label does not determine force; the normative keyword does.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

ID	FORM	FORCE	CLAUSE
LAW-DJANGO-001	LAW	MUST	Declared public behavior MUST have scoped implementation evidence and aligned developer guidance.
GUARD-DJANGO-002	GUARDRAIL	MUST NOT	DOCS MUST NOT knowingly describe behavior unsupported by accepted CODE.
POLICY-DJANGO-003	POLICY	SHOULD	Compatibility changes SHOULD record affected versions, migration guidance and scoped evidence.
CONTRACT-DJANGO-004	CONTRACT	MUST	Release evidence MUST distinguish proven behavior from illustrative material and MUST state its scope.
LAW-MEMORY-005	LAW	MUST NOT	MEMORY MUST NOT create new framework law unless promoted into SPEC.

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

CONFORMANT	CONFORMANT WITH EXCEPTION	NON-CONFORMANT	NOT YET PROVEN
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A **MUST** / **MUST NOT** deviation **MUST** be visible. An **EXCEPTION** / **WAIVER** **MUST** identify clause ID, scope, owner, rationale, evidence and review/expiry condition where applicable.

RELEASE LAW

Draft ≠ Tested ≠ Accepted ≠ Released. Claims **MUST** be scoped to evidence actually validated. An accepted release **MUST** record the exact four reviewed lane commits. The snapshot **MUST NOT** replace Git. One version, four squares, all green.

PAGE 2 — GOVERNANCE / DEVELOPMENT / EXCEPTIONS

Use when project complexity requires more than the one-page constitutional identity.

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DEVELOPMENT GOVERNANCE — RECOMMENDED CHECKLIST

- ☐ Material work **SHOULD** use a checklist or equivalent visible plan.
- ☐ Each material binding clause **MUST** have a stable clause ID and **SHOULD** map to a verification item and observable evidence.
- ☐ Agents **MAY** perform Discover → Plan → Execute → Observe → Verify → Record with defined responsibilities.
- ☐ LAW-AI-001 — When normative intent is ambiguous, agents **MUST NOT** silently choose a stronger or weaker interpretation; they **MUST** surface the ambiguity for review.
- ☐ Existing assets **SHOULD** be classified explicitly as REUSE, INHERIT or REFERENCE when project-boundary assumptions could otherwise leak.

EXCEPTION / WAIVER PROTOCOL

CLAUSE	SCOPE	OWNER	RATIONALE	EVIDENCE	REVIEW / EXPIRY
[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]

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